The Chamber of Chaff

Opined by Naman Bhotika, A journalist representing Reuters from the United Nations Security Council, on the agenda 'The Middle East Situation'.



(source: The Reuters)

There is a particular comedy in watching the United Nations Security Council sit in a deadlock. The council sits here deliberating on the situation in the middle east. However, the committee spends the majority of its time contesting the usage of legalities. It cannot be discerned whether the delegates simply do not know their legalities, or whether the nations are deliberately sabotaging progress.

The situation in the middle east is a veritable fishnet of proxy warfare and interventions. The state of Israel is currently bombing and occupying the territories of west bank and Gaza strip. The Islamic Republic of Iran is sponsoring terrorist groups including Hamas and Hezbollah.

The United States of America intervened in regional politics by conducting several airstrikes against Iran and Iran-backed groups. The Strait of Hormuz remains under constant threat from the IRGC forces. Maritime traffic has reached a mere 5-15% of pre-war traffic levels. The red sea also faces constant threat from the Houthi terrorist group.

The middle Eastern nations believe the council to be incompetent and inefficient. Governments are tired of 'Double Standards' and resolutions which cannot be enforced. Tehran points that the west uses the council for political pressure rather than mediation.

We have witnessed firsthand, how the council's selective enforcement of resolutions have chipped away at the credibility of international law. This council is failing to uphold the fundamental duty of maintaining world peace. In Gaza, Resolution 2803, for a ceasefire is ignored; In West Bank, resolution 2334, on settlement building, is again ignored.

Across the red sea, terrorist groups threaten trade everyday, which has led to a 12% decline in maritime traffic in the region. American fleets carry out illegal airstrikes across the region, leading to further destabilization of the region. Members sitting in the council spend time debating the use of Articles 2(4) and 51 of the U.N. Charter. Close to 30 minutes were spent contesting a mis-statement of a legality in committee; Close to 200 people die every hour in the middle east every thirty-minutes; This is precious time which was deliberately wasted by delegates of the western bloc to prevent any fruitful discussion which may curb the ambiguous freedom they currently enjoy.

This grievance may obscure the Middle Eastern Bloc's complicity in the decay it laments. While regional delegates invoke the sacrosanct nature of international law to cry against external intervention and multilateral settlements between the parties; they break their own posture through unconventional alignments with rivals and calculated avoiding of control standards set by ICJ precedents. Tehran calls the enforcement tools of the council (sanctions)

to be tools of Imperialist subjugation, while it continues to sponsor the armed non state actors which disrupt maritime traffic and violate the provisions of Resolution 1701of the Security Council. By treating compliance with the United Nations Charter not as a universal statutory duty but as a discretionary instrument to be deployed against adversaries and discarded for allies, the Middle Eastern bloc replicates the exact great-power cynicism it purports to oppose, ensuring that the council chamber remains an echo chamber for regional impunity rather than a conduit for genuine multilateral peace.

The Security Council will not fix its standing with weak calls for calm or small aid packages. Regional stability requires enforcing international humanitarian law, setting automatic Chapter VII penalties for border violations, and placing real monitors on the ground. If the chamber keeps offering paperwork to people facing daily war, it will confirm Logan Roy's line in *Succession*: the diplomats in New York are simply "not serious people". The council has a clear duty under international law, and that debt must eventually be settled.

Sources:

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